STANDARD 8

BIBLE KNOWLEDGE

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

UNIT	**PAGE**
UNIT 1 THE PROPHETS	2
UNIT 2 JESUS' TRIUMPHANT ENTRY INTO JERUSALEM	4
UNIT 3 HUMAN RIGHTS	5
UNIT 4 THE ARREST AND TRIALS OF JESUS	5
REFERENCE	7

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A prophet is a messenger of God.

FOUR MAIN PROPHETS SENT TO THE ISRAELITES

- Isaiah
- Jeremiah
- Amos
- Micah

IMPORTANCE OF PROPHETS (THE DUTIES OF PROPHETS)

- They remind people to be faithful
- They condemn people against their sins
- They warn people about God's punishment
- They foretell the future

HOW THE MESSAGES OF PROPHETS WERE CARRIED OUT

- Through sermons
- Through their behaviours
- Through their written words

THE MESSAGE OF ISAIAH (Isaiah 3:16-26)

Isaiah warned the Israelites that if they continued to rebel, God would punish them.

Isaiah's message was important because he was protecting them from God's punishment.

THE MESSAGE OF JEREMIAH (Jeremiah 1:1-19; 2:9-13; 4:1-4)

Jeremiah's mission was to warn the people of Jerusalem against idol worshipping.

Jeremiah told them to repent and come back to God.

Jeremiah's message was important because it teaches about reverence, love and protection of each other.

THE MESSAGE OF AMOS (Amos 2:6-8; 8:4-14; 9:1-4)

The mission of Amos was to preach the word of God to the people of the northern kingdom of Israel.

His message was against injustice, corruption, insecurity and oppression of the poor.

Amos' message is important because it teaches about love, empathy, patience, mercy and justice.

THE MESSAGE OF MICAH (Micah 2:1-13; 3:1-12; 7:1-7)

The mission of Micah was to warn the people of Judah against planning and doing evil.

His message was that God would punish them because of their injustice, corruption and oppression of the poor.

Micah's message is important because it teaches about justice, love and humility.

HOW GOD RULED THROUGH ISAIAH (Isaiah 1:2-31; 3:16-26)

Isaiah, son of Amoz, was one of the prophets that God chose to guide the Israelites.

God showed and revealed the message to Isaiah through a vision concerning Judah and Jerusalem during the time when Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz and Hezekiah were kings of Judah.

Isaiah warned the people of the two cities that God would punish them if they did not change from evil doing.

HOW GOD RULED THROUGH JEREMIAH (Jeremiah 1:1-19; 2:9-13; 4:1-4)

Jeremiah was the son of Hilkiah, one of the priests of the town of Anathoth.

The Lord spoke to Jeremiah when Josiah and his son Jehoiakim were kings of Judah.

He also spoke to him many times when Zedekiah son of Josiah was in his eleventh year of reign as king of Judah.

God guided Jeremiah by giving him words to speak to the people.

He was given authority over nations and kingdoms, to uproot and pull down, destroy and overthrow and to build and to plant.

God was with him throughout his mission.

HOW GOD RULED THROUGH AMOS (Amos 2:6-8; 8:4-14; 9:1-4)

God chose Amos, one of the shepherds from Tekoa to guide Israelites.

This was when Uzziah was king of Judah and Jeroboam, son Jehoash, was king of Israel.

God appointed Amos to guide the people of Israel against the oppression of the poor.

He told them about God's judgement that He would destroy them because of their sins.

HOW GOD RULED THROUGH MICAH (Micah 2:1-13; 3:1-12; 7:1-7)

Micah of Moresheth had a vision about a downfall of Samaria and Jerusalem.

God chose him when Jotham, Ahaz and Hezekiah were kings of Judah.

He was given responsibility to warn the people of Samaria and Jerusalem not to plan and do evil against others.

He guided them against the oppression of the poor and denounced the leaders of Israel for their corrupt practices.

UNIT 2 JESUS' TRIUMPHANT ENTRY INTO JERUSALEM

Triumphant entry means visiting a place as an honourable person.

OCCASIONS WHEN HONOURABLE PEOPLE VISIT A PLACE

- Political gatherings
- Wedding ceremonies
- Funeral ceremonies
- Chief's installation ceremonies
- Tribal gatherings
- Inauguration ceremonies

HOW PEOPLE REACT WHEN THEY ARE VISITED BY AN HONOURABLE PERSON

- ★ By singing
- ★ By dancing
- ★ By ululating
- ★ By eating special food
- ★ By giving them souvenir gifts

HOW JESUS ENTERED JERUSALEM (Matthew 21:1-17; Mark 11:1-9; Luke 19:28-48; John 12:12-19)

On the first day of the Passion Week, Jesus entered the holy city of Jerusalem in a humble manner while riding on a donkey.

People spread their clothes and branches of trees on the road.

They did this while singing in praise of God.

His entry into Jerusalem testified that he was the Messiah.

THE CLEANSING OF THE TEMPLE DURING THE PASSION WEEK (Matthew 21:12-17; Mark 11:15-19; Luke 19:45-48)

When Jesus entered the temple, He found people trading and exchanging money.

Angrily, He drove them out and overturned their tables as a way of cleansing the temple.

The chief priests and other religious leaders felt offended and were angered by His actions.

As a result, they plotted to kill Him.

UNIT 3 HUMAN RIGHTS

THE VALUE OF LIFE (Genesis 2:7; 4:14-15; Exodus 2:1-5; 20:13)

The value of life is that it makes every person a living being as created by God and that has the right to be alive and live freely.

The Bible teaches that killing through abortion or any other means is a sin.

It does not recommend capital punishment.

People violate the right to life through abortion and capital punishment.

They may also violate the right to life through abuse of power.

Christians should observe the value of life and promote good behaviour such as peace, unity, tolerance, love, justice, fairness and equality in society.

THE ABUSE OF POWER (Exodus 1:15-21; John 7:24; Romans 12:19)

Abuse of power is when a person uses his or her position for personal gains.

Or

Abuse of power is using one's position for personal gains.

This happens when a person holding a position is exercising his or her powers negatively against the demands of the law.

Power is usually abused through corrupt practices and unfair judgement.

It is important to fight against corruption by reporting all cases of abuse of power to the responsible authorities.

The Bible teaches people to make the right judgement.

Therefore, Christians should fight against corruption by spreading the spirit of love, tolerance and observing human rights.

UNIT 4 THE ARREST AND TRIALS OF JESUS

Arrest means taking and keeping somebody prisoner with the authority of the law.

Or

Arrest is to take and keep somebody prisoner with the authority of the law.

A trial is a process of finding out whether a person accused of a crime is guilty or innocent.

Or

Trial is a formal examination of evidence in a court of law to prove a suspect guilty or innocent.

THE ARREST OF JESUS (Matthew 26:47-56; Luke 22:47-53)

At the Passover feast, Jesus told His disciples about His arrest leading to His death.

He revealed that one of the disciples would betray Him.

After the Passover feast, Jesus went with His disciples to Gethsemane to pray.

After that, He took three of His disciples and went further.

Jesus left the three on one place and went a step further to pray alone.

Soon after praying for the third time, Judas, one of the disciples came with chief priests, officers of the temple guards and elders to arrest Jesus.

Judas identified Jesus with a kiss and the armed men arrested Jesus.

THE TRIALS OF JESUS (Matthew 27:11-26; Luke 22:66-71; 23:1-25)

There were many accusations made against Jesus.

ACCUSATIONS MADE AGAINST JESUS

- He was accused of refusing to pay tax
- He was accused of calling Himself a king
- He was accused of stirring up the people all over Judea by His teachings

When Jesus was arrested, two kings tried Him in Jerusalem.

Pilate asked Jesus questions and found Him not guilty of any offence.

Pilate then sent Jesus to Herod for another trial.

Herod asked Jesus many questions but Jesus did not answer them.

Herod also found nothing wrong in Jesus but ridiculed, mocked and sent Him back to Pilate.

Pilate then called the chief priests, rulers and the people and told them that Jesus did not commit any offence to deserve the death sentence.

The people insisted that Jesus should be crucified and Barabbas be released.

Then Pilate handed over Jesus to the people and released Barabbas.

REFERENCE

MIE (2008) Bible Knowledge Learner's Book for Standard 8, Domasi; MIE.